

long as smuggling of grey market goods—which are sold openly in most urban centres—remains unpunished.

Another aspect of the indivisibility of security is that any effort to protect cities will fail if the rural hinterland remains unpoliced. If terrorists have significant freedom of movement to plan and prepare their attacks in rural areas, the deployment of explosive devices, or the mounting of the final assault on targets in even the best protected cities, it presents no insurmountable challenge. Capacity generation for policing and intelligence at an unprecedented—indeed, hitherto unimagined—scale is required to recover the vast regions of India that have been given over to a vacuum of security and governance. A bogey is often raised that this will give rise to a 'police state'. This is nonsense. The choice is not between a degraded, inept, under-manned, ill-equipped and inefficient police, on the one hand, and a police state, on the other. A modern, efficient, humane force, bound by and committed to the rule of law, is a real and necessary alternative. Unless this is secured, India cannot be secured.

The reality of terrorism in India is that much of it remains collusive. This is brought out dramatically by the fact that Dawood Ibrahim, the architect of the devastating 1993 Bombay serial blasts (the largest terrorist attack in the country, with 257 fatalities), still controls one of the most comprehensive organised crime networks in India, more than a decade-and-a-half later, with deep collusive roots among elements of the political leadership. These roots effortlessly weave across political party lines and the religious divide. In the meanwhile, the 'D' Company has become a major Inter-Services Intelligence asset and a continuous collaborator with the Lashkar-e-Toiba and other Pakistan-backed terrorist groups, facilitating the movement of arms, explosives, terrorist cadres and finances across international boundaries, and the execution of attacks on Indian soil. In no civilised country of the world would this be possible; in India, it elicits no surprise—let alone outrage. Unless the criminal-terrorist-political nexus is disrupted and destroyed, terrorism will flourish.

India has extraordinary experience of counter-terrorism and counter-insurgency successes—Punjab, Tripura

and Andhra Pradesh are recent cases in point. Regrettably, there is a comprehensive lack of institutional memory and learning, and the experiences of the past have not been sufficiently studied, distilled and transferred to the present and emerging theatres of conflict. The result is that policymakers and security executives flounder continuously in the bogs of their own ignorance and confusion, chasing fruitlessly 'out of the box' solutions and politically correct slogans, ignoring the wealth of options that are immediately available right 'in the box'. Future policy options must be backed by the evidence of history and experience—and this demands processes of documentation,

analysis and dissemination that are currently entirely neglected. What has demonstrably succeeded must be applied. What has failed again and again must be abandoned. While this seems obvious, it is the exact opposite of the principal trends in India.

It is important to notice that no country has ever 'out-developed' an insurgency or terrorist movement: the 'developmental solution' has little support in history and is, indeed, a fraud on the people and has facilitated the looting of vast quantities of 'developmental funding' in terrorism-affected areas by corrupt politicians and administrators. The reality is that the time frames of counter-terrorism or counter-insurgency, and of development, cannot be reconciled. Terrorism and insurgency threaten the viability of democratic governance in the near term; developmental solutions can be realised—if at all—over the medium and far term. Indeed, this 'paradigm'

arises out of an almost puerile inversion of the general observation that 'developed countries' have a diminishing proclivity to political violence, particularly insurgencies and terrorism. There is, however, no single instance where an underdeveloped society has been able to neutralise an insurgency by magically fast-forwarding the development process.

These are the fundamentals around which the specifics of counter-terrorism policy and capacities will have to be constructed. If these remain unaddressed, the minutiae of force and capacity augmentation and deployment will have little—or at best, erratic—effect. ■

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